QP CODE: 25901061

B.Voc. Tourism Administration and Hospitality

MG1MDCTAH100- FRONT OFFICE AND HOUSEKEEPING

NOVEMBER 2025

Total marks : 70

PART A

1. What are the responsibilities of the front desk during the occupancy stage?

The front desk provides information, handles guest requests, and resolves complaints during the stay. It also maintains updated room status and posts guest charges accurately. Coordination with housekeeping and other departments is ensured to maintain guest comfort.

2.What is the main goal of yield management?

The main goal of yield management is to maximize revenue by adjusting room rates based on demand. It ensures rooms are sold at the most profitable price. This helps optimize occupancy and revenue per available room.

3. Explain the difference between consumable and non-consumable items

Consumable items are used up by guests and cannot be reused, such as soap, shampoo, or tissue paper. Non-consumable items are durable and reused repeatedly, like towels, irons, and hairdryers. Consumables are replenished daily, while non-consumables must be maintained.

4.Explain why guest satisfaction must be verified before check-out

Verifying satisfaction before check-out helps identify and resolve any issues immediately. It ensures the guest leaves with a positive impression. This increases the chances of repeat business and good reviews.

5. Explain the role of communication in conflict resolution

Effective communication helps employees understand the guest's problem clearly and respond politely. It reduces misunderstandings and builds trust. Good communication leads to quicker and smoother conflict resolution.

6. Analyse the reasons for linen loss and damage

Linen may be lost due to theft, misplacement, or being used for unintended purposes. Damage often occurs from harsh chemicals, frequent washing, or guest misuse. Poor handling by staff can also contribute.

7. Explain the advantages of online reservation systems

Online reservation systems allow customers to book rooms anytime from anywhere. They reduce manual errors and provide instant confirmation. Hotels also benefit from improved accuracy in availability and pricing.

8. Explain role of a public area supervisor

A public area supervisor ensures all public spaces like lobbies, corridors, and restrooms are clean and well-maintained. They supervise the cleaning staff and assign tasks. They also ensure standards of hygiene and safety are followed.

9.What Common mistakes to be avoided when taking reservations by phone?

Staff must avoid giving incorrect rates, dates, or room information. They should not fail to record essential details like guest name or contact number. Not confirming the reservation details at the end of the call is another common mistake.

10.Name Two special amenities provided during turndown service

Special amenities offered during turndown service may include chocolates or mints on the pillow. Fresh bottled water or bedtime slippers may also be provided. These amenities enhance evening comfort for the guest.

11. Explain the primary functions of the front office department.

The primary functions of the front office include welcoming and registering guests, providing information and services during their stay, and managing room assignments. It also handles billing, maintains guest accounts, and coordinates with other departments. The front office ensures smooth check-in, stay, and check-out for all guests.

12. Describe the steps involved in handling found property.

When an item is found, it must be immediately reported and handed over to the housekeeping or security department. The item is recorded in the Lost and Found Register with details like date, location, and description. It is safely stored until it is claimed, and proper identification is verified before returning it to the owner.

PART B

13. Discuss the integration of PMS with other hotel departments.

A Property Management System (PMS) integrates all major hotel departments to ensure smooth and efficient operations. It connects front office, housekeeping, food and beverage, sales, and accounts into one centralized platform. PMS allows real-time updates, such as room status changes from housekeeping to the front office. Billing information from restaurants and other outlets is posted automatically to guest folios. The system also helps reservations and sales teams track room availability accurately. PMS supports communication between maintenance and the front office by reporting faults instantly. It improves coordination and reduces errors caused by manual data entry. Managers can generate reports for occupancy, revenue, and staff productivity using PMS. Integration ensures faster service and enhances guest satisfaction. Overall, PMS acts as the technological backbone of hotel operations.

14. Explain the process of managing reservations received from online travel agents (OTAs).

When a reservation is made through an OTA, it is received instantly by the hotel through the channel manager or PMS. The system automatically updates room availability to avoid overbooking. The reservation team reviews details such as guest name, dates, room type, and payment method. They verify special requests and ensure they are arranged in advance. Confirmation is sent automatically to the guest and OTA. The reservation is assigned to a suitable room category based on availability. Payment details or guarantee methods provided by the OTA are checked carefully. Any changes or cancellations are updated in the PMS to keep records accurate. On the day of arrival, the front desk prepares for check-in using the reservation details. This process ensures smooth coordination between the hotel and OTA platforms.

15. Distinguish between express check-out and standard check-out.

Standard check-out requires the guest to visit the front desk, return keys, settle bills, and receive a printed invoice. It usually takes more time because the staff verifies all charges manually. Express check-out allows the guest to avoid standing in line by signing a pre-authorized form. In express check-out, the final bill is sent to the guest’s email and the payment is charged automatically.

Standard check-out involves direct interaction with staff, while express check-out minimizes physical contact. Guests with busy schedules prefer express check-out for convenience. Hotels use express check-out during peak hours to reduce crowding. Standard check-out allows guests to clarify any billing doubts immediately. Express check-out depends heavily on technology and accurate posting of charges. Both methods aim to provide a smooth departure experience based on guest preference.

16. Illustrate how inspection procedures help maintain hotel standards.

Inspection procedures ensure that guest rooms and public areas meet quality and cleanliness standards. Supervisors regularly check rooms after cleaning to verify that all tasks are properly completed. Inspection helps identify mistakes such as leftover dust, damaged items, or missing amenities. It ensures guest safety by checking electrical appliances, locks, and lighting. Regular inspections motivate staff to maintain high performance. They help maintain hotel reputation by ensuring consistent service quality. Inspection reports highlight areas that need training or improvement. The process helps reduce guest complaints and negative reviews. It ensures that maintenance issues are reported early before they become bigger problems. Overall, inspections help maintain a high standard of hygiene, comfort, and safety.

17. Why is effective communication essential in hotel operations?

Effective communication ensures that staff clearly understand guest needs and provide accurate services. It helps different departments coordinate tasks, such as room readiness between housekeeping and front office. Good communication reduces mistakes, delays, and misunderstandings. It creates a positive work environment and enhances teamwork. Staff can handle guest complaints more professionally with proper communication skills. Guests also feel valued when employees communicate politely and clearly. Clear communication ensures smooth check-in, service delivery, and check-out processes. It helps managers assign duties and monitor performance efficiently. Effective communication also supports safety procedures during emergencies. Overall, communication is essential for delivering consistent, high-quality hospitality service.

18. Explain the procedure for handling a group booking request.

Group booking begins with receiving details such as number of rooms, dates, purpose of visit, and special needs. The reservations team checks availability and prepares a group rate proposal. Once the client agrees, a formal contract is created and signed. The group's rooming list is collected before arrival. Rooms are blocked in the PMS to avoid overbooking. Coordination is done with housekeeping to prepare the required number of rooms. Front office arranges group check-in counters or pre-prepared keys. Billing instructions are confirmed, whether it is a master bill or individual payments. On arrival, the group is welcomed and guided to their rooms efficiently. After departure, the group bill is finalized and shared with the organizer.

PART C

19. Describe in detail the Guest Cycle and its importance in hotel operations.

The guest cycle refers to the complete journey of a guest from the moment they plan their stay until they leave the hotel. It consists of four main stages: pre-arrival, arrival, stay, and departure. During the pre-arrival stage, the guest gathers information, makes inquiries, and confirms a reservation. This stage is important because it creates the guest's first impression of the hotel. At the arrival stage, the guest checks in, provides identification, and receives their room assignment. The front office verifies booking details and ensures a smooth welcome. The stay stage involves fulfilling all guest needs, such as housekeeping, room service, and communication services. This period determines overall guest satisfaction because it is when the guest experiences hotel services directly. Staff must maintain quality, safety, and hospitality during this stage. The departure stage includes bill settlement, check-out, and collecting feedback. A smooth departure leaves the guest with a positive final impression. Each stage of the guest cycle requires coordination between multiple departments. Good communication ensures the guest receives timely and efficient service. The guest cycle helps hotels plan manpower, manage reservations, and maintain room inventory. It also helps track guest preferences for future visits. Proper monitoring of each stage reduces errors and complaints. The cycle allows hotels to identify areas for improvement in service delivery. Overall, the guest cycle is important because it ensures consistent service, guest satisfaction, and operational efficiency.

20. Discuss the key roles and responsibilities of housekeeping staff in a hotel, and explain their impact on smooth hotel operations.

Housekeeping staff play a crucial role in maintaining cleanliness, hygiene, and comfort in a hotel. Their main responsibility is cleaning guest rooms and ensuring they are neat and well-arranged. They also clean public areas such as lobbies, corridors, and restrooms. Housekeeping staff replenish amenities like towels, toiletries, and linen. They inspect rooms to ensure they meet hotel standards before guest arrival. They coordinate with the front office to update room status such as “vacant,” “occupied,” or “cleaning in progress.” Housekeeping also reports maintenance problems to the engineering department. They handle lost and found items according to hotel policy. They ensure proper laundry operations for guest clothes and hotel linen. Housekeeping staff contribute to guest safety by keeping floors dry and free from hazards. Their efficiency helps in quick check-in by preparing rooms on time. Good housekeeping creates a pleasant atmosphere that enhances guest satisfaction. Their work directly affects the hotel’s image and reputation. Housekeeping staff must maintain confidentiality and respect guest privacy. They also assist during emergencies such as fire or evacuation. Proper waste management and sanitation are part of their environmental responsibilities. Their teamwork ensures smooth coordination with all departments. Well-managed housekeeping operations reduce complaints and increase repeat business. Overall, housekeeping plays a vital role in delivering comfort and maintaining smooth hotel operations.